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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics Sept. 2023 – Expected 2027
University of California, Davis

- M.A. in Economics (en route to Ph.D.), 2024.

Visiting Student Researcher Jan. 2027 – May 2027 (expected)
Center on China's Economy and Institutions (SCCEI), Stanford University

M.M. in Agricultural Economics and Management Sept. 2020 – Jul. 2023
Renmin University of China

- Overall GPA: 3.90 / 4.00. Major GPA: 4.00 / 4.00 (top 1%).

B.A. in Economics Sept. 2016 – Jul. 2020
Capital University of Economics and Business

- Cumulative GPA: 4.38 / 5.00 (94.03 / 100; top 1%).

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary fields: Development Economics, Labor Economics
Secondary fields: Urban Economics, Machine Learning in Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Poor People or Poor Places? Evidence from China's Poverty Alleviation Relocation

Is extreme rural poverty a property of the people or the place? We study this question using China's Poverty Alleviation Relocation program, which moved 9.61 million residents out of remote villages between 2016 and 2020. Exploiting the staggered timing of destination housing construction, we estimate the impact of moving these communities closer to labor markets. Relocation increases adult employment by 20 percent and annual earnings by 38 percent. These gains occur among both new entrants to wage labor and existing workers. Per relocated adult, the rise in non-farm work comes to most of the gap between comparable town and village households. Heterogeneity analysis shows that earnings gains are largest for households experiencing the greatest reduction in travel time to the county seat. Combined with the value of new housing, the long-run income gains exceed the program's costs. We conclude that geographic isolation is a binding constraint on the earning potential of the remote poor. By relaxing this spatial constraint, relocation suggests that for these households the gap with the towns is largely a property of the place.

Presentations: Econometric Society NASM and AMES 2026; CES 2026; CUFE International Doctoral Forum; UC Davis ARE Development Seminar; ANU Asian Perspective Seminar (scheduled).

WORKING PAPERS

- **Bringing E-commerce to the Countryside: Impacts on Rural Household Welfare and Economic Inequality**, with Mingzhe Wang, Jia Tang, and Dongyue Chen. Revise and resubmit, *World Development*.
  Presentations: PacDev 2026; CES 2025; AAEA 2025 (poster); 12th ICCE.
- **Land as Old-Age Security: How Land Titling Reshapes Rural Labor Supply in China**, with Luoqi Yuan and Jianjun Tang. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Population Economics*.
  Presentations: GLO-JOPE Conference 2025; 17th CHLR Symposium on Human Capital and Labor Markets; Labor Science Education Committee Annual Meeting 2026 (scheduled).
- **Who Holds the Pen? Shared AI Advisors and the Defense of Screening Signals**. Prepared for submission to *Management Science*.
  Presentations: Economic Science Society Asia Meeting 2026 (scheduled).
- **Measuring and Controlling LLM-Agent Economic Behavior: A Memory-Augmented Framework with Sentiment Dynamics**, with Zongsheng Cao and Zigan Wang. Prepared for

submission to ICML.
Presentations: Econometric Society ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting 2026, Cornell.

- **Hit Items or Good Combinations? When Composition-Aware Bundle Recommendation Pays Off**. Prepared for submission to *Information Systems Research*.

PUBLICATIONS

Economics Journals

In English

- **Alleviating Multi-Dimensional Poverty through Land Transfer: Evidence from Poverty-Stricken Villages in China**, with Chengyou Li, Yong Jiao, and Tao Sun. *China Economic Review*, 2021.

In Chinese

- **债务偿还能力、信贷约束与农户生活水平** (Debt Repayment Capacity, Credit Constraints, and Rural Household Living Standards), with Meiyu Liu and Sujian Huang. 经济学动态 (*Economic Perspectives*), 2024(1).
- **从双重差分法到事件研究法** (From Difference-in-Differences to Event Studies), with Wei Huang and Ziyao Zhang. 产业经济评论 (*Review of Industrial Economics*), 2022(2). 600+ citations, 60,000+ downloads.
- **养老依赖、非农就业与中老年农户耕地租出——基于 CHARLS 三期面板数据分析** (Old-Age Dependence, Nonfarm Employment, and Farmland Renting-Out among Middle-Aged and Older Rural Households), with Chengyou Li, Luoqi Yuan, and Chuankun Kang. 中国软科学 (*China Soft Science*), 2020(7). Reprinted by Renmin University of China's *Photocopying Materials of Newspapers and Periodicals*.

Computer Science Conferences (peer-reviewed)
CCF-A and CCF-B: top and second tiers of the China Computer Federation (CCF) recommended conference list.

- **Seek-R1: Unifying Structured Knowledge Representation and Reinforcement Learning for Retrieval-Augmented Generation**, first author. *ACM International Conference on Multimedia (ACM MM)*, 2026. CCF-A.
- **EviDocVLM: Evidence-Aligned Reinforcement Learning for Multi-Page Document Question Answering**, first author. *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2026. CCF-B.
- **VideoTrace-R1: Long Video-based Retrieval-Augmented Generation via Reinforcement Learning**, co-first author. *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026. CCF-A.
- **ViG-RAG: Video-aware Graph Retrieval-Augmented Generation via Temporal and Semantic Hybrid Reasoning**, co-first author. *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)*, 2026. CCF-A.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Generative AI and the Minimum Scale of Knowledge Work**.
- **The Hospital Premium: Patient Sorting and Inpatient Spending in China**, with Yuzheng Wang.
- **Government Relocation and the Reorganization of Urban Economic Activity**, with Mingzhe Wang.
- **When Externalities Interact: Air Pollution, Driving, and Urban Congestion**, with Jing Cao, Xiangyu Du, and Chen Xi.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Sept. 2024 – Present
Department of Economics, UC Davis

- Economic History; Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I & II; Principles of Microeconomics; Economic Development.

Teaching Assistant Sept. 2020 – Jul. 2023
School of Agricultural Economics and Rural Development, Renmin University of China

- Advanced Econometrics; Dynamic Optimization; Principles of Economics; Applied Econometrics.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, LLM Agent and Vision-Language Model Training Oct. 2025 – Sept. 2026
Shanghai Artificial Intelligence Laboratory

- Trained retrieval and tool-use policies for LLM agents with reinforcement learning, and post-trained vision-language models for evidence-grounded document reasoning.

Research Assistant to Dr. Yiqing Xu Sept. 2022 – Jun. 2023
Stanford University

- Supported research on factor-based difference-in-differences and high-dimensional fixed-effects estimators; served as TA in the Lianxianghui econometrics training series on staggered DID.

Research Assistant to Dr. Chang Liu Jan. 2021 – Dec. 2022
Renmin University of China

- Contributed to an NSFC youth project on the economic impacts of the "universal two-child" policy on fertility and labor allocation.

HONORS & AWARDS

- Dean's Graduate Summer Support Award, UC Davis 2026
- Chinese Government Award for Outstanding Self-Financed Students Abroad (Category A) 2026
- Faculty-nominated invitation, CEGA Research Retreat (R^2), UC Berkeley 2026
- Faculty-nominated invitation, CPIR Graduate Student Retreat, UC Davis 2026
- Department Travel Award, UC Davis 2024–2026
- First Year Department Fellowship, Department of Economics, UC Davis 2023–2024
- Beijing Outstanding Graduate (top 1%), graduate and undergraduate 2020, 2023
- Outstanding Winner (top 0.25%), Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM) 2020
- National Scholarship (China's top academic scholarship for students) 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Student Organizer, Applied Micro Student Talk Series, UC Davis 2024–2026
- Student Organizer, Camphora Economic Circle (CEC) – Green Seedling Plan 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)
- **Software:** Stata, Python, R, LaTeX

REFERENCES

Giovanni Peri (Chair)
Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
UC Davis
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Diana Moreira
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